

r an existing customer|C,I - if the opportunity is for an existing customer|C,I||DRI||||

| Oversee a Proof of Value | Timeboxed mutually agreed upon evaluation of key business value.  
|I - if the opportunity is for an existing customer|C,I - if the opportunity is for an existing customer|||DRI||||

| Conduct a Technical Deep Dive Session | This is a deeper dive session on a custom use case important to the prospect or customer.||||DRI||||

| Create Customer Success Plan | A Customer Success Plan is a customer-facing and mutually agreed roadmap for achieving value through GitLab adoption. It is built off the information in the Command Plan and expands on it by including the customer's desired business outcomes, notional architectures of the current and proposed states, key stakeholders, and known risks. This strategy can also be a subset of the Opportunity Plan created by AEs or live on its own.||C,I|C,I||DRI|C,I||||

| Create ROI / Business Justification Plan | GitLab's Business Value Services practice is supported by the Field CTO team, the SA org, and Field Enablement to support deal and account teams (Account Executives and Solutions Architect) in incorporating business value consulting into the customer engagement.<br><br>This includes documenting and training on positioning and tooling to map GitLab value drivers to customer outcomes using a Return on Investment (ROI) and Total Cost of Ownership (TCO) analysis.||||DRI||C,I||||

| Position Professional Services ||C,I||DRI||C,I||||

| Position Success Plan Services ||C,I||DRI||C,I||||

| Identify Tech Champion (s) | Define and engage key user personas for solution tailoring.|C,I - when there is already an engagement following an existing closed deal||C,I||DRI||||

| Sales to Customer Success (CS) Handoff | Ensure detailed information transfer from sales to CS for seamless transition. |C,I|C,I||DRI||||

| Create Mutual Success Plan | Create joint success plan with the customer in order to document customer goals and primary use cases. |C,I|C,I||DRI||||

#### Journey Stage: Onboard

| Activities | Tasks | CSMA | CSA | AE | RM | SA | PS | Support | Executive Sponsor | Product and Engineering |

|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|

| CSM Kickoff & Intro | Introduce the customer to their CSM; outline the onboarding process and tools. |DRI||C,I||I||I||

| Technical Integration and Setup Support | Provide best practices on setting up GitLab (for example, architecture and deployment strategies) to fit customers' needs in line with our Documentation. |||C||I||DR - If PS was not attached, the CSM / CSA is the DRI and is responsible with providing customers best practices on setting up GitLab in line with customer's success objectives|||

| Establish Cadence Calls | Schedule and conduct regular progress check-ins with the customer. |DRI||I||I||I||I||

| Maintain Mutual Success Plan | Maintain and update mutual success plans outlining customer goals and success metrics. |DRI||C||C||C,I||

#### Journey Stage: Enable

| Activities | Tasks | CSMA | CSA | AE | RM | SA | PS | Support | Executive Sponsor | Product and Engineering |

|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|

| Use Case Enablement Workshops & Hands-on Trainings | Host workshops to enable and deepen

understanding of relevant use cases for functionalities that customers have already purchased or have licenses for. Standard content is provided; for customised content, customers should work with Professional Services (PS). |DRI|||I|||I|||

| Measure Primary Use Case Adoption | Track and analyze the adoption rate of primary use cases. |DRI|||I|||I|||

#### Journey Stage: Expand

| Activities | Tasks | CSMA | CSA | AE | RM | SA | PS | Support | Executive Sponsor | Product and Engineering |

|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|

| Expansion Discovery | Identify and pursue upsell and cross-sell opportunities. |C||C||DRI|||I|||

| Account Health Checkups | Conduct regular assessments of account health to ensure ongoing customer success. |DRI||C||C||I|||I|||

| Stakeholder Mapping and Engagement | Update and engage key stakeholders to maintain alignment and uncover new opportunities. |DRI||C||C||I|||I|||

| Position co-create initiatives | Introduce the customer to the initiative. |DRI|||I||C,I|||I|||

| co-create Kickoff & Intro | Introduce the customer to the co-create team. |DRI||C||I|||I|||I|||

| Facilitating communication | Supporting communication between co-create team and the customer. |DRI - CSM here is DRI until kick-off and will only step in to help if the co-create team need additional support after kick-off (initiative is at risk)||C||I|||I|||I|||

#### Journey Stage: Optimize & Renew

| Activities | Tasks | CSMA | CSA | AE | RM | SA | PS | Support | Executive Sponsor | Product and Engineering |

|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|

| Executive Business Review (EBR) | Conduct EBRs to review successes, challenges, and future plans. |DRI||C||C||I||C,I||

| Renewal Discussions | Initiate early discussions about renewal, leveraging insights from the customer journey. |C||C|DRI|C|I|||I|||

| Asking the "soft" renewal question. |DRI||C|C|I|||I|||

| Monitor Client Satisfaction | Implement a structured feedback process to capture and act on customer insights, driving continuous improvement. |DRI||I||I||I||I|||

| Facilitate Product Collaboration | Clearly capture customer needs through feature requests to assist Product Managers with feature prioritisation and product enhancement. |DRI||I||I||I||I||C,I||

| Ongoing Risk Review | Active management of risk in a customer account, quickly turning a customer to red when there is any potential risk of contraction or churn and frequently updating the status. |DRI||C|C|C|I||C||

| Risk and Escalation Management | Frequent communication to the account team about risk in their accounts and triggering/leading the escalation process (account escalation / STAR) where needed. |DRI||C|C|C|I||C,I||C|C,I||

| SPS Accelerator | Conduct regular health checks to identify areas for improvement. Provide access to GitLab's Accelerators, helping them optimize their use of GitLab's products for their specific needs, and assist in implementing them effectively. |C,I|DRI|C|I||I||C,I|||I|||

#### CSM interaction with Customers

- Understand and align on customer needs and goals; establish a mutually agreed success plan focusing on driving product adoption and growth.
  - Act as a trusted advisor by reviewing adoption metrics, offering perspectives on beta features, and conducting presentations and demos to enhance customer product knowledge and interest in order to drive adoption.
  - Serve as the main point of contact for customer inquiries, including feature requests and support ticket escalations / STAR.
  - Facilitate communication between customers and the product team to translate requirements into feature requests; arrange meetings with Product Managers (PMs) when necessary.
  - Regularly update customers on the status of their feature requests and any new feature updates.
  - Maintain ongoing communication to manage customer expectations; provide regular updates and best practices to enhance product adoption.
- Identify and flag risks to the appropriate teams while maintaining communication with GitLab support for issue resolution.
- Engage with PM and engineering teams to review releases and ensure they meet customer needs.
  - Triage technical queries effectively, redirecting to Professional Services (PS) or Support team as necessary.
  - Conduct regular calls and emails to maintain customer relations, and plan and deliver Executive Business Reviews (EBRs) to realign on goals.
  - Update and engage key stakeholders to maintain alignment and uncover new opportunities.

#### CSM interaction with cross-functional teams

- With Account Executives
  - Support on account planning
  - Surface opportunities and renewals
  - Regular touch points on customer health & assessing risk
  - Continuous alignment on strategic initiatives & objectives
  - Annual security and compliance questionnaires (part of renewal or procurement process)
- With Customer Advocacy / Events
  - Volunteering customers for speaking engagements
  - Referral program
  - Case studies to boost engagement
- With Partners
  - Align with partner on customer needs and success plan
  - Involve partner in all customer interactions
  - Discuss and agree with the partner on customer enablement
  - Update the partner on customer health
- With Product Team
  - Planning meeting for Feature Requests (FR), roadmaps, and SME sessions
  - Providing customer feedback when possible
  - Gathering first needs and use cases
  - Collaborate (advocating) with the Product team to shape the future of the GitLab platform
- With Professional Services Team
  - Understand when to engage with PS and how they can support

- Initiate discussions with the customer on potential PS engagements
- Understand customer expectations and relay them to the Engagement Manager
- Keep up to date with progress and current actions
- Offer additional follow-up options, such as Expert Services)
  
- With Renewal Managers
  - Engaging with renewal manager 4 months before the renewal
  - Prepare and support renewal discussion with renewal manager
  - Actively working with AE and renewal manager in case of risk
  
- With Sales Development Representatives (SDRs) and Business Development Representatives (BDRs)
  - AEs serve as facilitators, bridging CSM expertise and Sales/Business Development efforts into a unified strategy for account expansion, with CSMs providing support and insights as needed
  - Initiate early discussions about renewal, leveraging insights from the customer journey
  
- With Solutions Architects Team
  - Solutions Architects own:
    1. Pre-sales technical evaluation and relationships prior to the initial sale
      - Document customer business value and product fit
      - Define and engage key user personas for solution tailoring
      - Create joint success plan with the customer in order to document customer goals and primary use cases
    2. Tier upgrades and new business units (i.e., connected new) within an existing customer:
      - Product demonstrations and workshops, particularly when linked to a new opportunity (such as a tier upgrade or GitLab Duo demos directly associated with a prospective opportunity)
      - Identify and pursue upsell and cross-sell opportunities
    3. Ensure detailed information transfer from sales to CS for seamless transition
  - Customer Success Managers own:
    1. Post-sales customer relationship:
      - Demos and other product workshops when not associated to a new opportunity
    2. License expansion within an existing customer
    3. Update and engage with SA to maintain alignment and uncover new opportunities
    4. Conduct regular assessments of account health to ensure ongoing customer success
  
- Collaboration on Mutual Customer Success Plan - Merging of the Pre-Sales Customer Success Plan (owned by the SA - criteria) and the Post Sales CSM Customer Success Plan (owned by the CSM - criteria)
  
- With Support Team:
  - Maintaining communication in case of high and critical escalation
  - Effectively managing customer expectations for tickets that fall outside the scope of our usual support (out-of-scope tickets)
  - Educating customers on the GitLab Support process, which includes guiding them on managing contacts, explaining various SLAs based on priorities, and offering a comprehensive overview of GitLab Support coverage
  - Clearly communicating urgency and dependencies for tickets that demand immediate attention (STAR)
  - CSMs should ensure organization notes are kept up to date

## Account Team Meetings

The account team should meet in order to drive strategic growth towards accounts. Some reasons to meet with a customer account team:

- Coordinated customer growth/expansion strategies, including renewals and upgrades
- Onboarding of new customers requiring additional attention
- Triage if they have a health score other than Green

As a recommendation to make the most efficient use of everyone's time, these calls should not happen more than once a week, unless there is a specific and urgent need. There is no requirement to have recurring account team calls, but different regions and segments may approach account team alignments and engagement differently. For clarity on specific regions' or segments' approaches, reach out to the corresponding CSM Manager(s).

Account teams may choose to include the Sales Development Representative (SDR) in their account meetings for any targeted growth or wider account expansion.

### Who Leads the Meeting?

- No specific person/role is the boss. You are a TEAM.
- Tasks should be agreed upon during the SALSACSM meeting and fall into each person's area of responsibility.
- SAs and SAEs need to work together to ensure a smooth sales process, from discovery to demo to POV to final sale.
- SAs and CSMs need to work together to ensure a smooth transition for the customer.
- CSMs and SAEs need to work together to ensure a smooth onboarding, continued customer happiness, growing accounts, driving stage adoption, and to lock in the renewal for years to come.

### Tools to Use During the Meeting

- Working Agreement
- Salesforce
- Gainsight
- Customer collaboration project
- Customer meeting notes

### Leadership Alignment - Sales and CSM Management

The Area Sales Manager (ASM) and CSM Manager should also be meeting regularly (bi-weekly or monthly) to ensure cross functional alignment.

The CSM Manager is the DRI for the meeting, and topics to be covered at a management level include:

- Organizational updates: headcount changes, GTM strategy, process iterations, etc.
- Review red/at-risk accounts: current actions and help needed
- Renewal opportunities: forecasted churn rate for the current and next fiscal quarter, cross-check that projected ASM churn matches CSM projections

- Growth opportunities: accounts or opportunities where additional resources are needed, strategize on growth potential
- Feedback: individual team member wins and feedback

### Working Together throughout the Customer's Lifecycle

The SA owns all pre-sales technical relationships and activities. The SA coordinates conversations related to product, sales, business, and technical initiatives prior to the sale. CSM involvement during pre-sales models the expectations for the customer relationship after the sale, but should be limited to only after we achieve a technical win. CSM involvement should supplement, not displace, SA pre-sales ownership of the account.

When an account moves from pre-sales to post-sales, it is handed off from the Account Executive/Solutions Architect to the Customer Success Manager.

The CSM takes primary responsibility for the account once a customer becomes CSM-qualifying and focuses on ensuring customer success and driving adoption. SAs can be reintroduced in the following situations:

- A new POV for upgrade or additional team
- Transformative or dedicated professional services opportunities
- If a CSM is over-committed or unable to support a customer request, the SA may be requested to assist. However, the SA has discretion as to the level of involvement or assistance they provide post-sales.

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### ## SECTION: customer-success/apj-customer-success.md

The APJ Customer Success department is part of the GitLab Sales function under the WW Customer Success organisation who partners with our large, mid-market and strategic customers to deliver value throughout their GitLab adoption in the code development lifecycle.

The team can be reached in WW Customer Success Slack channel (internal only). Further to that, the APJ Customer Success team also communicates via our Slack channel (internal & private only) amongst themselves.

### Mission Statement

To deliver value to all customers by engaging in a consistent, repeatable, scalable way across defined segments so that customers see the value in their investment with GitLab, and we retain and drive growth within our enterprise customers.

- The mission of the Customer Success Department is to provide these customers with experience in order to:
  - Accelerate initial customer value
  - Maximize long-term, sustainable customer value
  - Improve overall customer satisfaction & referenceability
  - Maximize the total value of the customer to GitLab
  - To deliver value to all customers by engaging in a consistent, repeatable, scalable way

across defined segments so that customers see the value in their investment with GitLab, and we retain and drive growth within our enterprise customers.

## Vision Page

The WW "Customer Success Vision Page" provides the long-term vision which we also follow in the APJ Customer Success team.

## APJ Customer Success Team

Currently the local APJ CS team has Solutions Architects & Customer Success Managers in the team. The team reports to the Manager, Solutions Architects and the Manager, Customer Success Manager respectively.

- Manager, Solutions Architects responsibilities
- Solutions Architect responsibilities
- Manager, Customer Success Manager responsibilities
- Customer Success Manager responsibilities

Starting from the GitLab org chart the Manager, Solutions Architects reports to the WW Senior Director for Solutions Architecture who reports to the Vice President, Customer Success. The Manager, Customer Success Manager reports to the Senior Director, Technical Account Management who reports to the Vice President, Customer Success.

| Role                                     | Name            | Base location        |
|------------------------------------------|-----------------|----------------------|
| -----                                    | -----           | -----                |
| Manager, Solutions Architects            | Adrian Smolski  | Sydney, Australia    |
| Senior Solutions Architect               | Naoharu Sasaki  | Tokyo, Japan         |
| Senior Public Sector Solutions Architect | Shane Kelly     | Canberra, Australia  |
| Senior Solutions Architect               | Tomasz Skora    | Melbourne, Australia |
| Senior Solutions Architect               | Toshitaka Ito   | Tokyo, Japan         |
| Senior Solutions Architect               | Pedric Kng      | Singapore, Singapore |
| Solutions Architect                      | Inchul Yoo      | Seoul, South Korea   |
| Solutions Architect                      | Jonathan Lim    | Singapore, Singapore |
| Solutions Architect                      | Robert Williams | Sydney, Australia    |
| Manager, Customer Success Manager        | Dave Thompson   | Sydney, Australia    |
| Senior Customer Success Manager          | Benjamin Ma     | Sydney, Australia    |
| Customer Success Manager                 | Rohan Shah      | Mumbai, India        |
| Customer Success Manager                 | Zane J Chua     | Singapore, Singapore |

The APJ CS team currently does not follow a strict territory alignment. The only exception is that customers in the home base location would have a preference for Customer Success team members to ensure GitLab adoption. The APJ Customer Success team supports the Large and Mid-Market APJ outlines territories.

## Engagement options with the APJ Customer Success team

Any customer, customer prospect, GitLab Business Partner and/or GitLab Sales representative requiring assistance with GitLab's technology should be directed to the Customer Experience Manager (CEM).

Options to engage with the Customer Experience Manager are:

- Phone call
- Slack message
- GitLab Email
- GitLab Issue
- and other accessible GitLab communication tool

In exchange, all APJ Customer Success team members will document, capture and share (internally) all customer relevant information. We refer to the overview as the APJ Team Board - given the customer sensitivity and Customer Data sovereignty across different APJ regions and countries, this APJ Team Board is available only to GitLab team members.

The main focus is to efficiently centralise customer related information in one location utilising GitLab Kanban boards and document our work in GitLab Issues. We also share it internally across the APJ CS team as well as utilise the APJ Team Board as a follow up tool to ensure our customers success.

The CS team has also been building out a web-application to visualise the information captured by the APJ Team Board. The current goal is to complete that internal project referred as "SA Insights" by the end of FY21-Q2.

Who do we assist?

1. Our Enterprise and Mid-market customers
2. The Sales organisation (Large, Mid-Market & SMB)
3. The Channels organisation and our GitLab approved Business Partners
4. The local APJ Marketing organisation
5. The open-source community

The APJ Customer Success service offerings

1. Propose GitLab specific architectural guidance and justification for customer solutions (Solutions Engineering)
2. Respond to customer requests coming through to individual CS team members via email, slack, and other communication means
3. Address initial customer prospect technical and architectural conversations (Prospecting with Sales)
4. Engage with customers or prospective customers in technical evaluations of GitLab's offerings (Proof-of-Value)
5. Proposal and Architectural Documentation services for our customers
6. Attend conferences, meetups, events (community or formal professional) and provide talks, keynotes, presentations and DevOps thought-leadership

Returning back to GitLab and the Community

- Podcasts

Meetings & Structure



Our open-door policy encourages any discussion point, concern, suggestion, proposal and/or idea to be brought forward in any APJ Customer Success meeting in a positive and open manner.

#### Weekly Strategic meeting (all APJ CS team members)

Objective of the meeting: This is the weekly main meeting where all technical Solutions Architects as well as Customer Success Managers discuss strategy, highlights and lowlights of GitLab Platform related findings. Everyone in APJ Customer Success is encourage to partake in the meeting.

The APJ Customer Success team meets weekly to celebrate major customer achievements, reviews internal & external announcements related to GitLab, discusses company announcements, shares best customer success practises and acts as a tactical planning ground for success.

Duration: Between 60-90 minutes

Organiser: Customer Experience Manager

The meeting agenda is generally as follows:

- Prior to the start of the meeting, the Customer Experience Manager (CEM) activates and shares a songs which plays until around 1-2 mins past the hour to allow for team members to get ready and dial in
- The CEM shares their agenda (gdoc Doc) over the zoom session and presents the prioritized discussion topics
- The meeting generally kicks of with announcements, celebrations and updates from sales meetings, Customer Success meetings, and / or other company news
- Following the official part, the rest of the meeting is used for open discussions, presentations of key findings by individual team members and a open-door Q&A session
- Pro-activeness is encouraged within the team - interrupting and asking question is also encouraged
- Although the agenda priority is managed by the CEM - All team members are expected to bring forward topics for discussions

The meeting is scheduled regularly and on a weekly basis. The meeting is hosted via Zoom and the Meeting Agenda is shared via gdrive Docs and available internally.

#### Bi-Weekly GitLab New Release meeting (all APJ CS team members)

Objective of the meeting: Since GitLab Product is releasing new software every month, the APJ Customer Success team uses the opportunity to demonstrate main new GitLab functions and features to the entire team.

The APJ Customer Success team meets bi-weekly to attend this hands-on technical session. Each week we demonstrate 2-3 main topics from the past GitLab releases. The format is casual and mostly tailored towards the usage within the GitLab platform, a customer value discussion of the topic and exchange of customers who could benefit of the new functions.

Duration: Between up to 60 minutes

Organiser: Customer Experience Manager

The meeting agenda is generally as follows:

- Introduce Topic of interest and provide background information
- Demonstrate in GitLab's platform where the topic fits in and announce the GitLab Stage it belongs to
- Articulate the benefit of the Topic for our customers in APJ
- Clearly articulate which GitLab Tier the topic is benefited from
- Document your main finding in the internal bi-weekly GitLab New Release meeting document

The meeting is scheduled regularly and on a bi-weekly basis. The meeting is hosted via Zoom and the Meeting Agenda is shared via gdrive Docs and available internally.

Bi-Weekly APJ Team Coffee chat (all APJ CS team members welcomed)

Objective of the meeting: Bring any topic to the table in the APJ Team coffee chat. Following the GitLab Coffee Chat guidance, this is a social call.

The APJ Customer Success team meets bi-weekly to attend this optional coffee chat at the end of the week to discuss casual topics virtually. Topics of discussion can but do not have to be work-related. If a topic is work related, a retrospective overview and outcome can be discussed but the main interest should be the solution to the outcome versus asking for assistance.

Duration: Between up to 30 minutes

Organiser: All team members in APJ

No formal agenda is being utilised.

The meeting is scheduled regularly and on a bi-weekly basis. The meeting is hosted via Zoom and no Meeting Agenda is needed.

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## SECTION: customer-success/customer-content.md

<link rel="stylesheet" type="text/css" href="/stylesheets/biztech.css" />

Get familiar with GitLab

We've laid out a 5-day plan you and your team can use to begin learning about and using GitLab successfully.

Want to make this into a template to share with others in your organization? Create an issue template and build this template into your onboarding and training so your team can use GitLab to learn GitLab.

Day 1

- Watch the Intro to GitLab webinar - 1 hour.
- Complete the GitLab with Git Essentials Certification. This course can be completed lesson by lesson.

## Day 2

- Check out Getting Started with GitLab where you'll find a variety of comprehensive learning paths.

## Day 3

- Watch the Intro GitLab CI/CD webinar - 1 hour.
- Read about CI/CD concepts.
- Browse through some GitLab CI/CD Examples. We recommend bookmarking this page so you can refer back to it, as there is a lot of information available.
- Review CI/CD resources - including the GitLab CI Fundamentals learning path.

## Day 4

- Watch the Advanced CI/CD webinar - 1 hour.
- Work through the CI/CD Quick Start.
- Bookmark the CI/CD Keywords documentation for a list of all the configuration options for your .gitlab-ci.yml file.

## Day 5

- Watch the DevSecOps webinar - 30 minutes.
- Watch Adding Security to your GitLab CI/CD Pipeline - 5 minutes.
- Read how to secure your application.

## Additional resources

Once you're done with the steps above, take a look at:

- GitLab University and explore other trainings and resources.
- Learn GitLab with tutorials for a variety of video and tutorials on a range of topics.

## Stay up to date with new features

GitLab releases a new version every month. Stay up to date on new features and capabilities by reading the release posts on our blog.

## Want to learn more?

Consider the following GitLab certificate courses:

- GitLab Certified Git Associate
- GitLab Certified Project Management Associate
- GitLab Certified CI/CD Associate
- GitLab Certified Security Specialist

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## ## SECTION: customer-success/customer-terrain-mapping.md

Customer Terrain Mapping Engagements provide customers with the benefit of GitLab's experience with DevOps methodologies, Git, GitLab, CI, CD and monitoring by brainstorming a high level, first draft discovery of their specific challenges that need to be addressed for success in a scoped area of DevOps (a Terrain). The need for this generally arises when the customer is getting ready to utilize technologies and/or methodologies they are less familiar with.

### Terrain Mapping Design Goals

- Focus on discovering customer concerns in a scoped area (a Terrain) to apply GitLab solutions to their specific challenges on the ground.
- Facilitate collaboration with customers on articulating critical success factors by co-creating a first draft of a terrain map.
- To help customers and GitLab team members understand scenarios where professional services may play a significant and direct role in ensuring customers can be more successful with implementing and gaining value from GitLab. This directly supports the publicly stated mission of GitLab Professional Services as being an extension of Customer Success.
- Generate results rapidly and efficiently through a co-worked document outlining considerations and scope in as little as one 60 minute session.
- To enable reuse and extension, leverage single templates that include brief embedded training and instructions.
- To enable diversity and inclusivity of inputs by using an open collaboration event to build out the deliverable.
- Give the customer a first draft terrain map that can be iteratively improved.
- To exhibit transparency by articulating all the things that are required for success, regardless of whether GitLab has services to offer for the items.
- All of the above goals work together to broaden the scope of who can facilitate the session. Facilitation generally requires a technical background, but it is not limited to any specific technical role within GitLab.

### Some Qualifiers

- Regardless of whether the customer chooses not to use professional services, the document is a high-value artifact that they can develop further.
- The Customer Terrain Mapping activity does not include detailed design discussions nor doing the actual work to make progress on any of the identified items.
- Generally one Customer Terrain Map is offered per SA customer engagement.
- If the customer chooses to use an applicable professional service, the engagement document will help rapidly understand the customer perspectives to scope and price the engagement. (Efficient reuse)

### Further Iterations of Customer Terrain Maps

Like anything in the handbook, it is everyone's responsibility and prerogative to improve these materials through corrections and enhancements. At the same time, Terrain Mapping reflects adherence to specific design principles to deliver the items documented above in Customer Terrain Mapping Design Goals. For those wishing to make substantial changes or generate

entirely new Terrain maps, these design principles are documented here: [Terrain Mapping Overview and Design Principles \(GitLab Team Members Only\)](#)

## GitLab Internal Enablement and Preparation Resources

Each Terrain Mapping Engagement Template has an instructions and preparation section that helps you get up to speed as quickly as possible.

For background, please also watch the original CS Enablement session - a link and instructions are provided near the top of [Terrain Mapping Overview and Design Principles \(GitLab Team Members Only\)](#)

## Catalog of Customer Terrain Mapping Engagements

Preparation instructions are contained in each of the below. Some items are only accessible by GitLab Team members.

Please be sure to include all the sections when updating or adding Engagements.

1. [Terrain Mapping for Self Managed Implementation Review](#)
2. [Terrain Mapping for Developer Skill Ramping Onto GitLab CI and CD](#)
3. [Terrain Mapping Best Practices GitLab Self Managed](#)
4. [Terrain Mapping for GitLab Migration Review](#)
5. [Terrain Mapping for Gitflows, Workflow, Roles and Controls for SCM, CI and CD](#)
6. [Terrain Mapping for Implementing GitLab Secure](#)
7. [Terrain Mapping for Customer Internal Developer Enablement for GitLab CI](#)
8. [Terrain Mapping For Specialized or Highly Scaled GitLab Runner Implementation](#)
9. [Terrain Mapping for Integrating GitLab with Other Systems](#)

## Terrain Mapping for Self Managed Implementation Review

Status: Ready

### Common Customer Challenge

- Implementing the Self Managed GitLab

### Customer Applicability Cues

- Volume Cue: "We have over 3000 users that will be using our self managed GitLab instance and we need to ensure that its going to scale"
- Velocity Cue: "We would like to have GitLab installed and configured within our Production environment by the end of this QTR"
- Complexity Cue: " Our organization requires that GitLab be deployed Highly Available and with Disaster Recovery"
- Experienced with Consuming Professional Services Cue: "There are many components that make up GitLab and we would like your experts to set this up for us so that we get started on a solid foundation"

### Customers Transitions That Indicate a Potential Need For This

- Initial Purchase of Self Managed

#### Existing Professional Services That May Help

- Implementation Rapid Results Self-Managed
- Implementation Rapid Results .com
- Dedicated Implementation Planning

#### Preparation Materials

- Preparation materials (GitLab Team Members Only)

#### Outline: Terrain Mapping for Self Managed Implementation Review

1. Project Overview
2. Architecture Approach and Rationale
3. Right sizing the implementation
4. Architecture Tradeoffs
5. Risk/issues and Mitigations
6. Solution Alternatives
7. Key Decision Points
8. Concerns
9. Key Assumptions

#### Terrain Mapping for Developer Skill Ramping Onto GitLab CI and CD

Status: Ready

#### Common Customer Challenge

- Making Teams Productive on GitLab (Learning)

#### Customer Applicability Cues

- Volume Cue: "We have about 300 people that would need to learn how to be productive on this new system"
- Velocity Cue: "If we don't get everyone up to speed before the 4th QTR starts, then we will have to wait until next year"
- Complexity Cue: "GitLab has a lot of moving parts and understanding how to best manage and operate this platform is going to be difficult"
- Experienced with Consuming Professional Services Cue: "Training is essential to success when adopting any solution within our organization and we hope that GitLab can provide educational services"

#### Customers Transitions That Indicate a Potential Need For This

- Initial Purchase
- Renewal
- CI Stage Adoption

## Existing Professional Services That May Help

- Education Services

## Preparation Materials

- Preparation materials (GitLab Team Members Only)

## Outline: Terrain Mapping for Developer Skill Ramping Onto GitLab CI and CD

1. Teams and Users
2. Developer Focus
3. Project Manager / Scrum Master Focus
4. CI / CD Scope
5. Shifting Security Left
6. CI Coding Skills
7. Simultaneous Changes
8. Workflow / Change Gate Refactoring
9. Integrations and Webhooks
10. Encouraging Engagement and Completion
11. Timeline

## Terrain Mapping Best Practices GitLab Self Managed

Status: Ready

## Common Customer Challenge

- How to ensure GitLab is run as a production grade internal service when self managed.

## Customer Applicability Cues

- Complexity Cues: "How do we backup the new instance and how do we test our disaster recovery ability?"  
"How do we assign permissions to the many runners we will have?"
- Experienced with Consuming Professional Services Cue: "Do you have documentation on all the activities we will need to undertake to manage our self-managed instance similar to how you run GitLab.com?"

## Customers Transitions That Indicate a Potential Need For This

- Initial Purchase of Self-Managed
- Re-Platforming Existing GitLab Installation
- Moving to from GitLab SaaS to Self-Managed
- Stability Issues / Version Stagnation of Existing Self Managed GitLab Instance

#### Existing Professional Services That May Help

- Implementation Rapid Results Self-Managed
- Dedicated Implementation Planning

#### Preparation Materials

- Preparation materials (GitLab Team Members Only)

#### Outline: Terrain Mapping Best Practices

#### For Operating Self Managed GitLab as a Production-Grade Internal Service

1. Teams and Users
2. Existing Pipeline Code Analysis
3. Existing Pipeline 3rd Party Integrations
4. Developer Enablement (templating for rapid onboarding)
5. Shifting Security Left
6. CI / CD Scaling Requirements
7. New Integrations and Webhooks
8. What Specific Existing Pipeline Features Should be Templated
9. Tool Retirements / Consolidation
10. What Deployment Environments Need to Be Supported
11. Timeline

#### Terrain Mapping for GitLab Migration Review

Status: Ready

#### Common Customer Challenge

- Data and/or Integrated Systems Cutover Into GitLab (All at once migration)

#### Customer Applicability Cues

- Volume Cue: "We will be migrating over 300 projects/repos (GIT) from our previous SCM that needs to be migrated over to GitLab"
- Velocity Cue: "We need to migrate/transcribe over 500 pipelines from our previous CI/CD tool before we can even begin to use GitLab"
- Complexity Cue: "We are new to GIT and would need our current codebase converted from SVN/TFS/CVS to GIT in order to use GitLab"
- Experienced with Consuming Professional Services Cue: "We have many repos that need to be migrated or converted to GIT and we don't have the time or resources to do it ourselves and require your services"



## Customers Transitions That Indicate a Potential Need For This

- Initial Purchase

## Existing Professional Services That May Help

- Migration Services

## Preparation Materials

- Preparation materials (GitLab Team Members Only)

## Outline: GitLab Migration Review

1. Business Background
2. Scope & Approach
3. Migration Complexity Questions
4. Risk/issues and Mitigations
5. Team App Feature Delivery Velocity Allocation
6. Timeline

## Terrain Mapping for Gitflows, Workflow, Roles and Controls for SCM, CI and CD

Status: Ready

## Common Customer Challenge

- Creating a GitFlow / GitLab Flow for Code and Possibly Deployment Including Workflow Controls

## Customer Applicability Cues

- Volume Cue: "We need all 83 of our development teams to be using the same GitFlow processes and it seems like it will be difficult to reculture one team at a time."
- Velocity Cue: "We want developers to be upgrading their workflow control game as they onboard to the new GitLab based DevOps services we are defining."
- Complexity Cue: "There are so many settings and possibilities for GitLab Workflow that our developers are struggling to understand what to configure to both to adapt and improve our current process when moving to GitLab."
- Experienced with Consuming Professional Services Cue: "Can you provide professional services to help us come up with a new model of our code quality and deployment workflows?"

## Customers Transitions That Indicate a Potential Need For This

- Initial Purchase
- CI Stage Adoption
- CD Stage Adoption

## Existing Professional Services That May Help

- Education Services

## Preparation Materials

- Preparation materials (GitLab Team Members Only)

## Outline: Terrain Mapping for Gitflows, Workflow, Roles and Controls for SCM, CI and CD

1. Teams and Users
2. Code Integrity
3. Who Should Be Involved in Code Review
4. What Should Merge Approvals Look Like
5. What Should Branch Protections Look Like
6. Critical Files / Directories To Protect
7. Separation of Duties
8. Protected Branches, Tags, Environments and Runners
9. Compliance Requirements
10. Microservices Workflows
11. Who Should Be Involved in Deployment Approval
12. Deployment Complexity
13. User Specific Group Hierarchy
14. Repository Group Hierarchy
15. Audit Activities and Roles
16. Timeline

## Terrain Mapping for Implementing GitLab Secure

Status: Ready

## Common Customer Challenge

- Helping customers plan for successful implementation of GitLab Secure

## Customer Applicability Cues

- Volume Cue: "We need all 52 of our development teams to be up their DevSecOps game as soon as possible."
- Velocity Cue: "We want all developers to be leveraging GitLab Secure features within two quarters of purchasing it."
- Complexity Cue: "We loved the demos, but we have to admit we are a bit overwhelmed by exactly what configuration should be implemented to ensure we are leveraging the full Secure feature set."
- Experienced with Consuming Professional Services Cue: "Can your professional services area work with us to define and build a working example project that leverages all of the GitLab Secure capabilities we need?"

#### Customers Transitions That Indicate a Potential Need For This

- Initial Purchase
- CI Stage Adoption
- GitLab Secure Adoption

#### Existing Professional Services That May Help

-

#### Preparation Materials

- Preparation materials (GitLab Team Members Only)

#### Outline: Terrain Mapping for Implementing GitLab Secure

1. Terrain Mapping for Implementing GitLab Secure
2. Teams and Users
3. Development Build & Test Workflows (Development Remediation)
  1. Code Integrity
  2. Code Quality
  3. Security Scanning
  4. Security Findings Practices
  5. Merge Approvals
  6. Issue Creation
4. Sprint Planned Remediation
  1. Creation of Issues
5. Defend Workflows
  1. Kubernetes
  2. Scheduled Scanning / DAST
6. Security Audits

## 7. Licenses Audits

## 8. Timeline

### Terrain Mapping for Customer Internal Developer Enablement for GitLab CI

Status: Ready

#### Common Customer Challenge

- Helping customers understand and configure parts of GitLab that create internal enablement for their Development Teams

#### Customer Applicability Cues

- You Are Talking to an Enablement Team Cue: "We generally make templates for the other developers.", "Our team is responsible for all organization-wide shared development tooling", "Our new effort will be providing many more shared and structured services for all developers."
- Velocity Cue: "We want all developers to be leveraging GitLab Secure features within two quarters of purchasing it."
- Complexity Cue: "We need our existing strongly opinionated Development / DevOps workflows to be setup in a way that developers can easily understand how to do in GitLab."
- Experienced with Consuming Professional Services Cue: "Can your professional services area work with us to define and build a working example project that leverages all of the GitLab Secure capabilities we need?"

#### Customers Transitions That Indicate a Potential Need For This

- Initial Purchase
- CI Stage Adoption

#### Existing Professional Services That May Help

-

#### Preparation Materials

- Preparation materials (GitLab Team Members Only)

#### Outline: Terrain Mapping for Customer Internal Developer Enablement for GitLab CI

1. Teams and Users
2. Existing Pipeline Code Analysis
3. Existing Pipeline 3rd Party Integrations
4. Developer Enablement (templating for rapid onboarding)
5. Shifting Security Left

6. CI / CD Scaling Requirements

7. New Integrations and Webhooks

8. What Specific Existing Pipeline Features Should be Templated

9. Tool Retirements / Consolidation

10. What Deployment Environments Need to Be Supported

11. Timeline

Terrain Mapping For Specialized or Highly Scaled GitLab Runner Implementation

Status: Proposed

Common Customer Challenge

· Help customers with specialized, complex and highly scaled self managed GitLab Runner Implementation Planning including ML Ops and Data Ops

Customer Applicability Cues

- Volume Cue: "Every team will have a runner in each of their 3 cloud accounts - it seems like a lot to manage the initial deployments and long term maintenance."
- "We will be pushing ML Ops data sets for our AI project that will requires massive elastic scaling."
- Velocity Cue: "We need a runner per team operational on the launch of GitLab."
- Complexity Cue: "Our production environment cloud account is zero touch - how can GitLab runners be setup to deploy into that cloud account?"
- Experienced with Consuming Professional Services Cue: "Can we have professional services help us design an approach to self-managed runners that will work for us?"

Customers Transitions That Indicate a Potential Need For This

- Initial Purchase
- CI Stage Adoption
- ML Ops or Data Ops

Existing Professional Services That May Help

-

Preparation Materials

- Preparation materials (GitLab Team Members Only)

Outline: Terrain Mapping For Specialized or Highly Scaled GitLab Runner Implementation

1. Teams and Users

2. Existing Pipeline Code Analysis
3. Existing Pipeline 3rd Party Integrations
4. Developer Enablement (templating for rapid onboarding)
5. Shifting Security Left
6. CI / CD Scaling Requirements
7. ML Ops / Data Ops
8. New Integrations and Webhooks
9. What Specific Existing Pipeline Features Should be Templated
10. Tool Retirements / Consolidation
11. What Deployment Environments Need to Be Supported
12. Timeline

Terrain Mapping for Integrating GitLab with Other Systems

Status: Proposed

Common Customer Challenge

- Wiring Up the Platform to Existing Systems (Integration)

Customer Applicability Cues

- Volume Cue: "We rely/depend on too many other services as a part of our workflow that we can't replace at this at this time (Slack, Jira, Jenkins, etc) "
- Velocity Cue: "We need these integrations day one before we can start using GitLab"
- Complexity Cue: " Connecting all the integrations required is going to impact developer productivity and we can't affect our customer value/product delivery"
- Experienced with Consuming Professional Services Cue: "Do you provide any services that could help us tie in these required components?"

Customers Transitions That Indicate a Potential Need For This

- Initial Purchase
- Broadening GitLab Usage To Enterprise Wide

Existing Professional Services That May Help

- Integration Services

Preparation Materials

- None yet

Outline: None Yet

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## SECTION: customer-success/education-enablement.md

Overview of GitLab Product Training

As a Solutions Architect, Customer Success Manager, or Professional Services Engineer, it is important to be continuously learning more about our product and related industry topics. This handbook page provides an dashboard of aggregated resources that we encourage you to use to get up to speed. Although we aggregated and/or developed these resources for Customer Success team members, they are generic enough that all team members and partners can benefit from the education and enablement resources that we have published here.

## Overview of GitLab Feature and Use Cases

The GitLab product is organized based on the DevOps stages.

### DevOps Stages

If you're new to GitLab and the concept of "stages" are new to you, simply think of it as a category of related features that a customer finds value in with a technical narrative. The stages are organized in an infinite loop diagram to show the software development lifecycle from planning to development to release, with additional value for deployed applications with security and monitoring features. You can see a high-level overview of each stage on the marketing page. Be sure to click the Learn More link for each stage to see more about the features of that stage.

One of the most helpful resources for understanding what GitLab does, the features in each stage, and how well the feature works is our Category maturity chart. This may also be informally referred to as our "lovable feature chart".

If you understand what the stages are and want to dive deeper, you can look at the product categories handbook page for a deep-dive on each of the stages, specifically the hierarchy and the DevOps Stages.

For the purposes of education and enablement, we focus on the DevOps stages that the customer sees. There are additional stages that help GitLab as a business succeed, such as the Growth stage, Fulfillment stage, Enablement stage, and Single Engineer Groups stage. Although these are not necessarily DevOps stages, the Engineering and Product departments use the stage terminology for consistency. You do not need to spend time learning about these stages and can search for this information later if the need arises.

### GitLab Product Topics

To align our education and enablement with our product, each of the topics below are grouped based on how GitLab product management and engineering defines it.

### DevOps Sections

#### Foundations Level

- Manage Stage Overview
- Manage Stage Direction and Roadmap

## Intermediate Level

- Value Stream Management Feature Docs
- Audit Events Feature Docs
- DevOps Reports Feature Docs
- Code Analytics Feature Docs
- Compliance Management Feature Docs
- Audit Reports Feature Docs

## Plan Stage

## Foundations Level

- Create Stage Overview
- Create Stage Direction and Roadmap

## Intermediate Level

- Source Code Management Feature Overview
- Source Code Management Direction and Roadmap
- Code Review Feature Overview with 30+ Features
  - JIRA Integration Solution Overview
  - JIRA Issues Integration Feature Docs
  - JIRA Development Panel Integration Feature Docs
  - Multiple approvers in code review Feature Docs
  - Approval rules for code review Feature Docs
  - Merge request dependencies Feature Docs
  - Code Owners Feature Docs
- Wiki Feature Docs
- Web IDE Feature Docs
- Live Preview Feature Docs
- Snippets Feature Docs
- Gitaly Source Code Project

## Verify Stage

## Foundations Level

- Package Stage Overview
- Package Stage Direction and Roadmap

## Intermediate Level

- Package Registry Feature Docs
- Container Registry Feature Docs
- Helm Chart Registry Feature Docs



- Dependency Proxy Feature Docs
- Dependency Firewall Direction and Roadmap
- Release Evidence Feature Docs
- Git LFS - Feature Docs

## Release Stage

### Foundations Level

- Configure Stage Overview
- Configure Stage Direction and Roadmap

### Intermediate Level

- Auto DevOps Feature Overview
- Auto DevOps Feature Docs
- Kubernetes Management Feature Overview
- Secrets Management CI Variable Docs
- ChatOps Feature Docs
- Serverless Feature Overview
- Infrastructure-as-Code Feature Docs

## Monitor Stage

### Foundations Level

- Secure Stage Overview
- Secure Stage Direction and Roadmap

### Intermediate Level

- Static Application Security Testing (SAST) Feature Docs
- Dynamic Application Security Testing (DAST) Feature Docs
- Fuzz Testing Feature Docs
- Dependency Scanning Feature Docs
- License Compliance Feature Docs
- Secret Detection Feature Docs
- Vulnerability Management Feature Docs

## Govern Stage

### Foundations Level

- Kubernetes for Beginners Udemy Training

- CKA Udemy Training
- CKAD Udemy Training

Intermediate Level

- Kubernetes Documentation

Advanced Level

- CKA Certification
- CKAD Certification
- CKS Certification

Infrastructure-as-Code

HashiCorp Terraform

Foundations Level

- Hashicorp Learn Tutorials

Intermediate Level

- TODO

Advanced Level

- Vault Associate Certification

HashiCorp Consul

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Foundations Level

- Hashicorp Learn Tutorials

Intermediate Level

- TODO

Advanced Level

- Consul Associate Certification

O'Reilly Content Library

In order to facilitate an environment of learning and development, the Customer Success Team

has access to the O'Reilly Learning Platform, which is integrated into GitLab Learn. This content library contains thousands of books, videos and live learning courses to assist team members' with professional development and staying up-to-date with changing technology trends. Additionally, code sandboxes are included within the O'Reilly platform that team members's can utilize to practice new skills or hone existing ones.

To get started, here is a quick tour of what the O'Reilly Learning Platform can provide to our team, please check out this short introductory video.

If you do not already have a login are outside of the customer success organization, please let the Corporate Learning and Development Team know you are interested. You can also purchase a single licesne with the GitLab pricing by contacting Jason Baca at [jbaca@oreilly.com](mailto:jbaca@oreilly.com).

### O'Reilly Answer Slack Bot

As part of GitLab's O'Reilly subscription, team members have access to the O'Reilly Answer Slack Bot. To get started, in Slack, just type `/oreilly-answers` followed by your tech question. It's that simple.

For example:

- `/oreilly-answers` How do I fine-tune a model?
- O'Reilly Answers will respond to your question with highly relevant snippets of content right within Slack.

### More Answers

Use the "More Answers" button to flip through the suggested answers. O'Reilly will show a maximum of 8 possible answers and you'll be taken back to the first answer when you get to the end.

### Full Text

To read the full text of an answer in context click the "Full Text" button and you'll be taken directly to that snippet of content within the O'Reilly Learning platform.

### Share Answers

To share a helpful answer with others in Slack click the "Post" button and the answer you selected will be posted to the channel where you asked the question.

If you want to share an answer in a private channel you'll need to invite the O'Reilly Answers app to the channel first. Simply type: `/invite @O'Reilly Answers`

If you want to share an answer in a direct message you'll need to create a group message and include O'Reilly Answers in the group. You can add O'Reilly Answers the same way you would add another person.

### Additional Resources

- Field Enablement Handbook Page
- Field Accreditation Handbook Page
- Sales Training
- Communities of Practice
- Learn at GitLab
- GitLab Releases

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## SECTION: customer-success/faq.md

## Customer Success FAQ Charter

Team members in Customer Success face questions from customers every day about a variety of topics related to GitLab. In an effort to maintain GitLab's values of collaboration, results, efficiency, Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging, iteration, and transparency, we are collectively updating this FAQ as a Customer Success team with questions received by customers, in the hope to help other GitLab team members (both in and out of Customer Success), our customers, and our wider GitLab community.

If you ask a question in Slack or another avenue and receive an answer, please add to this page. If the Q&A was in Slack, post the link to the MR in the thread so others can know it's been documented. If you see a question hasn't been documented, please take the initiative to document it and share. Everyone can contribute!

1.

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## SECTION: customer-success/pre-sales-post-sales-transition.md

As a member of the pre-sales team, closing another successful deal for GitLab, it is important to pave the way for the CSM. A successful CSM introduction is a critical step in the customer lifecycle. An effective CSM introduction will lead to customer excitement about the product and increase the CSM's credibility as they assist the customer through onboarding, implementation, and adoption.

<!-- NOTE: This course probably needs to be checked to ensure it's not conflicting with the new guidelines -->

Please review this course on Introducing the Customer Success Manager.

## Engaging a CSM/CSE

Not all accounts qualify for a CSM or CSE. Please view this internal wiki page with ARR thresholds by sales segment to determine if your account qualifies for either a CSM or CSE.

To determine if an account already has a CSM assigned, go to the Salesforce account page, scroll to the Customer Success section, and see if there is an entry for Customer Success Manager (this should be right below the Solutions Architect). If a person is listed there, they are the CSM and you can reach out to them about the account. If TAM Scale is listed instead of

a person, that means that the account is supported by a CSE. To get a CSE engaged with the account, please reference this handbook page on how to request engagement.

If you have questions about CSM alignment (either for existing or newly-qualifying customers), please reach out to the CSM Manager supporting that region (see this handbook page for details).

If a customer will be on Dedicated, the account team should notify the CSM Manager they work with and familiarize themselves with the best practices for engaging CSMs for Dedicated Customers to get them engaged during the pre-sales process.

#### Transition Quick Summary

| --- | --- |  
| Who coordinates the CSM introduction? | Solutions Architect |  
| When does the introduction happen? | 3-Technical Evaluation or 4-Proposal |  
| Why does the introduction happen at this stage? | Introduce the CSM when business value discussions are still being had within the account, allowing them to build relationships with the key strategic decision-makers and help the customer visualize their implementation journey. This sets the CSM up for continued engagement at the right level within the account. |  
| How does the introduction get scheduled? | SA will schedule a "Welcome to GitLab" call with the customer team, after having synced internally with the full account team (inc. CSM) |  
| Where can the CSM access account information? | - Customer Meeting Notes Doc <br> - Command Plan <br> - Account Plan <br> - Customer Strategy/Value Plan|

#### CSM Transition Process

We want to introduce the CSM to the customer while they are still a prospect nearing the end of stage 3-Technical Evaluation or when transitioning to 4-Proposal.

Why do we begin the transition prior to the sale?

This is a great time to introduce the CSM to the decision-makers and key stakeholders, while the SA still has regular contact and a close working relationship. These business counterparts aren't usually involved in future cadence calls, so fostering that relationship early helps CSMs to engage with the stakeholders in the business that are best positioned to help drive adoption, build a successful goals-oriented partnership and ultimately, lead to improved success planning, EBRs, etc.

Additionally, CSM engagement can be requested earlier in stage 3-Technical Evaluation (but not before) in the following situations:

- If a POV has been conducted - Upon POV completion & results presentation meeting where the next steps agreed upon

<!--

NOTE: I'm not convinced these are valid reasons to engage a CSM prior to stage 3, which is what we are now talking about...

- A shared customer issue tracking project has been created that will affect the account long-term
  - As requested by the SA if the CSM has a specific subject matter expertise relevant to the conversation
- >

How does the SA engage with the CSM?

In order to ensure the CSM workload is distributed effectively, SAs should reach out to the relevant CSM Manager in their region to request a CSM to be assigned to the account. As part of this process, SAs should provide at least the following information:

- Salesforce link to the Account
- Salesforce link to the Opportunity
- Expected Close Date
- Landed Addressable Market (LAM) (GitLab internal Link) of the Account

After a CSM is assigned by the manager, the SA should arrange an internal account team meeting.

#### Internal Account Team Meeting

In preparation for transitioning the account to post-sales, the CSM should schedule a meeting with the entire account team to review details about the customer and the success plan. The account team should use the following questions to review details, and define the next steps near-, medium-, and long-term for the customer adoption journey:

- What are the customer's objectives & measurable success criteria for the next 6-12 months?
- For each objective discussed, ensure we have answers to the following:
- Initiative - What activity are we completing?
  - Business Outcome - What customer-defined result do we need to achieve?
  - Success Criteria - How do we measure success?
  - Timeline - When will this be done, and what are our milestones along the way?
  - Who are the decision maker(s) and stakeholders for GitLab? When is our next meeting with each of them?
  - What will we discuss in our EBR with the customer 6 months from now?

Agenda for the meeting:

- Account Information
  - Name of organisation
  - Industry / sector they operate in
  - Any recent news articles about them, or the sector
  - Current Tool Stack
- Key people
  - Champion
  - Decision maker / economic buyer
  - Main points of contact
- Command Plan and reasons for purchasing GitLab
  - Defined business outcomes
  - Pain points

- Metrics
- Impediments to adoption and known risks
- Services engagement
  - Scope and deliverables
  - Timeline
- Customer Strategy Plan
  - Background
  - Solutions Alternatives/Obstacles
  - Roles
    - In Scope
    - Out of Scope
  - Target Benefits
  - Key Stakeholders
- Open Support Tickets

If the Solutions Architect has created a collaboration project, the account team should review it together, and ensure that readme.md details and issues are up to date.

#### CSM introduction to the customer

Following the internal account team meeting, the SA should set up a CSM introduction meeting with the customer. When arranging this meeting, the SA can provide the customer with a high-level overview of the CSM role, and what the CSM engagement might look like going forward. However, the SA (and SAE) should refrain from making any statements on behalf of the CSM, as to what activities they will do.

Prior to the customer meeting, the CSM should work with the SA to prepare the CSM program overview deck & Customer Strategy Plan Summary-Page to be presented as part of the introduction client meeting. This will be starting point of the CSM's relationship with the customer, and it's important to convey what the CSM's role is, the CSM's understanding of the customer's initiative's and mutually agreed upon timeline(s), and the general expectations from both sides moving forward.

While the opportunity progresses through commercial discussions, the CSM should engage with the SA where appropriate, in order to maintain the relationships with the strategic personnel and decision makers within the organisation.

#### Shifting responsibility from SAE & SA to CSM

Once the opportunity moves stage to Closed Won the CSM should schedule the kickoff meeting with the customer to go into more detail about the customer's objectives and the CSM program. Please review the details for the CSM kickoff call to learn more about how to conduct this meeting.

Now that the account is in post-sales, the CSM takes primary responsibility for guidance & best practices conversations, customer enablement, and product usage. Most responsibilities of the SAE & SA will transition to the CSM at this point.

During customer onboarding, the SA may choose to stay engaged with the customer to help facilitate a seamless introduction and address any ongoing activities from the POV. This should be done in such a way as to allow the CSM to take over those activities, so all conversations

with the customer on these items should include the CSM.

Once the account is fully transitioned to post-sales, the SA may be invited by the CSM to re-engage under certain circumstances.

### Re-Engaging the SAE/AE and SA

There are instances where the CSM will need to reengage the SAE/AE and SA. Here are a few examples of customer requests the CSM can listen for in order to reengage them:

- Development of expansion plans with the SAE and CSM leading to tier upgrades
- A POV, product evaluation, RFP, or security begins for a "new" single team or an enterprise-wide tier upgrade not for renewal purposes
- SAs may assist CSMs with an existing customer team on an exception basis. SA leadership approval is required.
  - Customer enablement assistance when specifically requested by the CSM team
  - Workshops assistance when specifically requested by the CSM team
  - ROI analysis for an existing customer team when requested by the CSM team
  - Unless it's for a tier upgrade, presales activities such as POVs and RFPs should be avoided for an existing customer team. Like with any presales opportunity, these activities should not be offered as a sales tool, but leveraged when a prospect/customer requires these activities as part of their evaluation.
- Any Professional Services that are being discussed and may require an SOW
- If a CSM is over-committed or unable to support a customer request, the SA may be requested to assist
- Support of GitLab days or other on-site evangelism of GitLab at customer sites
- Executive Business Reviews (EBRs)

### Useful Links

us-public-sector parent project for all public sector work

account-management parent project for account-specific work and collaboration with the rest of the sales

customer-success parent project for Customer Success employee, shared or triage work

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## SECTION: customer-success/reporting-and-dashboarding-framework.md

### Problem statement

We have multiple systems (Salesforce, Gainsight, Tableau) where reporting can take place. Confusion and inefficiencies are created in the Field and Operations for when to use which tool and why. Furthermore, we need clear, crisp definitions to empower Ops and Strategy to guide stakeholders on reporting best practices.

### Vision



Each tool has a different value driver. Each report must address, "what is the primary purpose of the report/dashboard? To be operationalized or develop visuals/insights?"

#### Framework

- Operationalize: Use Gainsight and Salesforce when the purpose is to operationalize, such as a list of contacts to engage or CTAs to update. Typically for front-line and managers
- Insights and recommendations: Use Sisense/Tableau for slide deck visualizations, trend analyses, and to develop insights and recommendations. Typically for Leadership and deck preparation

#### Example design

##### Tableau

Deliver insights: Field-wide C360 view of contract info, usage data, health data, Marketing campaigns, attribution data, PtC/PtE. Generally for exec/BOD and analytical reporting

- QBR prep: create dashboards to help CSM Managers and SA leaders create quantitative QBR stories - users: CS management/leadership
- CS KPIs: core CS KPIs - users: CS Analytics/CS Leadership+
- Coverage: CSM/usage data coverage dashboards - u